

Gonzalo Ballestero

Department of Economics
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Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Pennsylvania State University	2022 – 2028 (expected)
M.A. in Economics, Universidad de San Andres	2020 – 2021
B.A. <i>magna cum laude</i> in Economics, Universidad de Buenos Aires	2015 – 2019

Research Interests

Industrial Organization, Market Design, Economics of Artificial Intelligence, Behavioral Economics

Publications

[Strategic Algorithmic Monoculture: Experimental Evidence from Coordination Games](#), with Hadi Hosseini, Samarth Khanna, and Ran I. Shorrer. *Proceedings of the 27th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC' 26)*, Extended Abstract, April 2026. [arXiv 2604.09502](#)

[Algorithmic Collusion under Sequential Pricing and Stochastic Costs](#). *International Journal of Industrial Organization*, June 2026. [SSRN 5203084](#)

Working Papers

Brain Drain by Design

The Pitfalls of Preferential Admission Policies

Publications Prior to PhD

A Regulatory Framework for Nanotechnology in Argentina (*in Spanish*), with Pablo Herrera and Javier García Fronti, *Nanotecnología y Sociedad en Argentina*. Vol. I, pp. 183-200, 2021

A Note on the Kuhn-Tucker Theorem: Revisiting Constraint Qualifications (*in Spanish*), with Pablo Herrera, *Revista de Investigación en Modelos Matemáticos Aplicados a la Gestión y la Economía*, Vol. II (6) pp. 23-34, August 2019

Policy Briefs

Cheating in the Medical Residency Entrance Exam in Argentina (*in Spanish*), July 2025

Redesigning the National Medical Match in Argentina: Toward More Equitable Access (*in Spanish*), with Mariana Gudiño and Nahir Lera, June 2025. Featured in [Penn State News](#), [Clarín](#), [La Nación](#)

Conferences and Seminars

2026: EARIE Annual Conference (Mannheim); ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (Rome); ESIF Conference on Economics and AI+ML (Cornell); Universidad de San Andres; Peruvian Medical Society; Penn State AI and the Economy Initiative Inaugural Workshop; Penn State Applied Micro Brown Bag ($\times 2$).

2025: Midwest Economic Theory Conference (Virginia Tech), Ministry of Health of Argentina;

Penn State Center for Socially Responsible Artificial Intelligence; Penn State Applied Micro Brown Bag ($\times 2$); Penn State Trade and Development Brown Bag; Penn State Theory Lunch.

2024 – 2021: Pennsylvania Economic Theory Conference (Poster Presentation); Penn State Theory Lunch; Penn State Applied Micro Brown Bag; Argentinian Association of Political Economy Annual Conference (Buenos Aires).

Professional Service

Co-Organizer of the [AI and the Economy Initiative](#), Pennsylvania State University, 2026

Organizer of the Applied Microeconomics Reading Group, Pennsylvania State University, 2025

Professional Development

Summer Institute in AI and Economics, University of Chicago Booth School of Business, 2026

Summer School in Market Design, EARIE (Mannheim), 2026

Summer School in Dynamic Structural Econometrics, Econometric Society (London), 2025

Summer School in AI and Industrial Organization, EARIE (Amsterdam), 2024

Research Experience

Research Assistant for Prof. Hadi Hosseini, Pennsylvania State University	2026
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Research Assistant for Prof. Ran I. Shorrer, Pennsylvania State University	2024 – 2025
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Research Assistant for Prof. M. Florencia Gabrielli, Universidad de San Andres	2021 – 2022
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Research Assistant for Prof. Pablo Herrera, Universidad de Buenos Aires	2018 – 2020
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Teaching Experience

Guest Lecturer, Applied and Quantitative Economics (Graduate), Spring 2026, Penn State

Guest Lecturer, Development Economics (Graduate), Fall 2025, Penn State

Teaching Assistant, Economics of Matching (Undergraduate), Spring 2024, Penn State

Teaching Assistant, Advanced Econometrics (Graduate), Fall 2024, Penn State

Guest Lecturer, Industrial Organization (Graduate), Fall 2021, Universidad de San Andres

Awards, Honors, Fellowships, and Grants

Fox Scholarly & Professional Impact Award (USD 10,000), Pennsylvania State University, 2026

Edward J. Green Graduate Fund (USD 1,000), Pennsylvania State University, 2026

Travel Grant ($2 \times$ USD 500), Pennsylvania State University, 2026

Research & Graduate Studies Dissertation Award (USD 7,500), Pennsylvania State University, 2026

Travel Grant ($2 \times$ USD 500), Pennsylvania State University, 2025

Finalist for the Neil Wallace Best Third-Year Paper Award, Pennsylvania State University, 2025

Graduate Fellowship, Pennsylvania State University, 2022 – 2026

Young Researcher Award, Argentinian Association of Political Economy, 2021

Graduate Fellowship, Universidad de San Andres, 2020

Academic Excellence Award *magna cum laude*, Universidad de Buenos Aires, 2019

Research Assistantship, Universidad de Buenos Aires, 2018 – 2019